Garrett Galayda

Lead Product Designer

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Skills
Product Design
Product Strategy
Design Systems
Service Design

Tools
Figma
Replit
Claude Code
Adobe
ChatGPT
Lovable
NotebookLM

Technical
HTML
CSS
JavaScript
Prototyping

Education
Bachelor of Arts
Visual Communications
International Academy
of Design & Technology
Chicago, IL

Product design leader with experience building scalable digital products across payments, marketplaces, and consumer platforms. Skilled at transforming complex technical and business challenges into intuitive user experiences.

Staff Product Designer
Braintree (PayPal) / 2018–Present

Lead product design across a global enterprise payments platform processing $1.5T in annual transaction volume. Identified and self-initiated a value-added services adoption platform that became an organization-wide OKR initiative, driving measurable margin growth for Braintree's largest merchants.

Architect end-to-end product experiences spanning merchant onboarding, lifecycle engagement, and platform adoption. Operate at the intersection of business strategy, engineering constraints, and user needs, translating complexity into intuitive, scalable solutions.

Grew the design team from three to five designers and secured dedicated UX research and content design resources by demonstrating design's direct impact on business outcomes.

Partner with product and engineering leadership to shape roadmap priorities. Bring a systems-thinking approach to technically complex problems, with a track record of influencing org direction without formal authority.

Mentor designers and build a critique culture grounded in psychological safety, equipping the team to represent design confidently across the wider organization.

Freelance Product Designer
The Parking Spot / 2016–2018

Redesigned the end-to-end customer experience across web, mobile, and airport kiosk surfaces. Simplified complex booking and loyalty flows into intuitive customer journeys that reduced friction at every touchpoint.

Established design as a formal practice within the organization through weekly feature sprints, iterative product work, and cross-functional collaboration across product, marketing, and engineering. Defined the UX patterns that became the foundation for the company's design system.

Design Director
Doejo / 2010–2016

Built and led the design practice for a product agency serving startups and Fortune 500 clients across marketplace and consumer application categories.

Designed the foundational product experience for Reverb.com, a global marketplace for buying and selling musical instruments, from early concept through launch. The platform was later acquired by Etsy.

Designed BuzzDraft, a real-time fantasy sports platform powered by live data streams, taking the product from napkin concept to launch and eventual acquisition.

Translated early-stage product thinking into MVPs and production-ready designs in close collaboration with engineering, operating as a product partner as much as a design lead.